



India could become a solar power battery hub: PM Modi

Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi recently wondered whether India could become a hub for solar power battery manufacturing, which could play a major role in the country's march towards clean energy. Responding to a question when asked for his comments on the global challenge of climate change, the PM gave the example of cellphones, citing that their popularity increased more and more as the size of their batteries decreased.

The PM was speaking at Eastern Economic Forum (EEF) in the pres-

ence of Russian President Vladimir Putin, Japanese PM Shinzo Abe, Malaysian PM Mahathir Mohamad and Mongolian President Khaltmaagiin Battulga. He said that India, as part of its goal to generate 175GW of clean energy by 2022, is focusing on solar power in a big way.

Expressing confidence that India will achieve this target, the PM also said that he wants to see whether India could become a hub for solar power battery manufacturing, and that he has invited companies in the field to discuss the matter further.

MeitY to push for more incentives to attract electronics manufacturers

The government's Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) will push Ministry of Finance to approve additional incentives to attract electronics manufacturers into the country, government officials have said. As per a report in *Economic Times*, sops include interest subsidy on loans, credit guarantees for plant and machinery, and renewal of the electronics manufacturing cluster (EMC) scheme after the earlier one ended last year. The incentives will help India wean manu-

facturers away from countries such as China, officials said, especially after the government announced that new manufacturing units will only be taxed at a rate of fifteen per cent.

Only last month, finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman had announced that new manufacturing firms incorporated on or after October 1 this year will pay a corporate tax at the rate of fifteen per cent. Sitharaman had also cut the effective corporate tax from 30 to 25.17 per cent.

ISRO spectrum demand likely to hit 5G rollout in India

According to a recent report by PTI, industry experts think that spectrum demand of Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) is likely to hit the rollout of 5G services in India.

ISRO wants to use 26GHz band, in which the 5G ecosystem has been developed. Department of Telecom (DoT) has accepted their demand, and also submitted a proposal to

International Telecommunications Union. The proposal allows the use of 26GHz band for mobile services and also ensures that 5G services will not interfere with satellite operations.

Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI) director general Rajan S. Mathews said that the power condition per base station proposed by the government is lower than that used for

ON THE move



R.M. Agarwal takes additional charge as chairman and MD, ITI Ltd

Pursuant to the order of Ministry of Communications, Department of Telecommunications, R.M. Agarwal, director - marketing, ITI Ltd, has taken additional charge as chairman and managing director (MD) of the company, with effect from October 1, 2019, following the retirement of K. Alagesan, director - production with additional charge of chief managing director (CMD).

Harman appoints Vikram Kher as VP in India

Harman, a wholly-owned subsidiary of Samsung Electronics, has announced the appointment of Vikram Kher as vice president (VP) for its lifestyle audio division in India. Kher's last role was with PayTM as VP in the e-commerce category management. Kher will be responsible for sales, operations and marketing of the consumer audio category.

Infogain appoints Narayan Kamat as VP and global head of data, analytics and AI

Infogain has announced the appointment of Narayan Kamat as vice president and global head of data, analytics and AI (artificial intelligence), based out of Infogain's Los Gatos office. Kamat will focus on AI and analytics-driven digital and data transformation services, and manage successful business outcomes for Infogain clients.

Wi-Fi hotspots. It will be very difficult to transmit voice at this limit.

DoT will have only around 1.25GHz to 1.5GHz of spectrum in 26GHz for 5G services in total. An operator will require at least 1GHz of spectrum in the higher frequency band—proposed 26GHz band at present—to roll out 5G as stated by International Telecommunication Union (ITU). Critical 5G applications may fail if sufficient bandwidth is not provided.

He further stated that the 5G network is designed to meet both require-